

ENGLISH CORE (301)

Reconstructed Question Paper — 2025

This is a reconstruction from the submitted answer booklet. Only questions whose wording/topic could be recovered with reasonable confidence are included; missing source passages and obscured questions are not invented.

Section A — Reading Comprehension

Q.1 Read the passage on humour and answer the following questions:

- (i) What does the writer mean by humour?
- (ii) Explain how humour can help people deal with difficult situations and maintain relationships.
- (iii) How can humour become harmful when it is used at another person's expense?
- (iv) Explain how jokes, witty remarks and observations can reveal the social world around us.
- (v) Identify the expression/phrase in the passage that means “light-hearted humour”.

Q.2 Read the passage on changing skill requirements and employment opportunities and answer the following:

- (i) What is the latest trend in the changing skill requirements of the job market?
- (ii) What difficulties do female respondents face in gaining work experience and employment opportunities?
- (iii) Explain the difference between adoption and experimentation in the context of skill development.
- (iv) What percentage of respondents were interested in pursuing a skill-development programme?

Section B — Creative Writing Skills

Q.3 You are the Head Boy/Head Girl of ABC Public School, Mumbai. Draft a notice informing students of Classes IX–XII about a Road Safety Awareness Workshop to be conducted from 18–20 March 2025 at the school sports ground. Mention that the workshop will include traffic-safety demonstrations and an address by a police superintendent.

Q.4 You are Mrs. Savita Manimekhal. Write a formal reply declining an invitation to judge an inter-school debate competition because you have a prior engagement. Follow the formal letter format.

Q.5 You are Ajay, a resident of Pune. Write an application to the Principal of Bloom Public School for the post of Hockey Coach advertised in *The Hindu*. Include your educational qualifications, coaching experience, achievements and relevant enclosures.

Section C — Literature / Long Answer

Q.6 Answer the questions based on the prescribed literature text(s) dealing with social attitudes, humour, relationships and human behaviour.

Q.7 Write a long answer explaining how the central character/situation in the prescribed text reveals an important social or human concern. Support your answer with relevant textual details.

Note: The exact passages and several literature questions are not sufficiently visible in the answer booklet and therefore are not reproduced as if they were certain.